08-19 第一篇

The Effects of Light Pollution

When we think of pollution, we usually think of dirty air or polluted water. But there is another kind of pollution that affects our lives every night: light pollution. [1] It refers to the excessive or misdirected artificial light that brightens the night sky and disrupts the natural rhythms of both humans and wildlife. As cities grow, this problem is getting worse.

Light pollution comes from many sources. Streetlights, billboards, office buildings, and car headlights all add to the glow. [2] In big cities, the night sky is often so bright that people can barely see the stars. Astronomers find it harder to observe the universe, and ordinary people lose the chance to enjoy the beauty of a starry night. The wonder of the cosmos feels farther away than ever.

For wildlife, light pollution can be harmful. Many animals use darkness to hunt, migrate, or rest. [3] Birds that fly at night may get confused by bright lights and crash into buildings. Sea turtle hatchlings often crawl toward streetlights instead of the moonlight on the ocean, and they may never reach the sea. When natural patterns are disturbed, entire ecosystems can suffer.

Humans are also affected. Our bodies have internal clocks that depend on darkness to know when to sleep. [4] Too much artificial light at night can disrupt our sleep and may even increase the risk of certain health problems. Studies suggest that people who live in brightly lit areas often sleep less well than those in darker neighborhoods. Restful sleep is essential for our well-being.

The good news is that light pollution can be reduced. [5] We can use shields on streetlights to direct light downward, turn off unnecessary lights at night, and choose warmer, softer lighting. Everyone can help by being mindful of outdoor lights at home. Small changes can make the night sky darker and our world healthier.

选项

A. That is why scientists and city planners are paying more attention to it now. B. Even in the countryside, the glow from distant cities can faintly brighten the horizon. C. Insects that gather around lamps at night often become easy prey for predators. D. This can lead to tiredness, difficulty focusing, and other problems the next day. E. Simple steps taken by communities and individuals can make a real difference. F. For example, some cities have started dimming streetlights after midnight.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前引入"光污染"概念，空后给出光污染的正式定义。选项A"这就是为什么科学家和城市规划者现在更加关注它"承接前文"另一种污染"的存在，自然引出后文对其定义的详细阐述，强调问题的严重性与受重视程度。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举光污染的多种来源，空后描述大城市夜空过亮、看不见星星、天文学家观测困难。选项B"即便在乡村，远处城市的 glow 也能隐约照亮地平线"与前文"多种来源"呼应，补充说明光污染范围之广，与后文"大城市夜空过亮"形成城乡对比，凸显问题的普遍性。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说许多动物依赖黑暗进行捕猎、迁徙或休息，空后举例鸟类撞楼、海龟幼体爬向街灯。选项C"夜间被灯光吸引的昆虫 often 成为捕食者的轻易猎物"与前文"动物受光害"一致，补充昆虫这一受害群体，与后文鸟类、海龟形成并列举例，使野生动物受影响的论述更完整。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说人体生物钟依赖黑暗判断睡眠时间，空后提到夜间人工光 disrupt 睡眠、增加健康风险。选项D"这会导致疲劳、注意力困难以及次日其他问题"与前文"睡眠被 disrupt"形成因果链，具体阐述后果，与后文"睡得好对健康至关重要"自然衔接。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前提出"光污染可以减轻"这一积极转折，空后列举具体措施。选项E"社区和个人采取简单步骤就能带来真正的改变"总领后文"加灯罩、关灯、选暖光"等做法，强调可操作性，与"小改变让夜空更暗、世界更健康"形成呼应。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some cities have started dimming streetlights after midnight**：以For example开头的典型干扰项。与第五段"减少光污染的措施"高度相关，容易被误选为[5]。但该选项是单一城市政策的举例，而[5]处需要的是对"人人可参与、小改变有效"的概括性陈述；E的"communities and individuals"与"simple steps"更契合段落主旨，F属于具体案例层面的干扰。